



Working choppers

Wallis WA-116 UK 1961

Wooden body keeps weight down to 256lb (116kg)

The Wallis starred in the **James Bond** film *You Only Live Twice*.

Cabin shell made of composite materials over a titanium frame

Mil Mi-8 Russia 1961

Large rear door for cargo

Exhaust for turboshaft engine

Hughes OH-6A USA 1965

Small, twin-bladed tail rotor

Robinson R22 Beta USA 1985

Lightweight tail boom

Schweizer 269C USA 1989

Landing skids

Tail fin stabilizes the rear during flight

The ability to hover in midair makes helicopters ideal platforms for aerial photography, search and rescue, and reconnaissance missions. They can also operate from isolated areas and city helipads, ferrying people and supplies.

The 1960s saw the production of both tiny autogiros and giant helicopters. The single-seater **Wallis WA-116** was just 11 ft 2 in (3.4m) long, but could fly more than 125 miles (200km), while the **Mil Mi-8** was 60 ft (18.2m) long and could carry 27 people or 6,614lb (3,000kg) of cargo. Biggest